



HOANG NGOC DIEU TRAN

Selected works - Urban
2026



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Timeline

July 2025 - present Urban planner and Urban designer
FREELANCE - SELF EMPLOYED

Sep 2023 - July 2025 MSc. Urbanism, Landscape and Planning
KU LEUVEN

Oct 2024 - June 2025 Student job
KU LEUVEN

July 2024 - Aug 2024 Internship
METAPOLIS

Feb 2023 - Jul 2023 Urban Planner
AIM REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT AND DEVELOPMENT JSC - KOG GROUP

Dec 2019 - Dec 2022 Urban planner
SURBANA JURONG - VIET NAM OFFICE

Aug 2017 - Aug 2019 Urban planner
NDA GROUP - NEW DESIGN ASSOCIATES

Mar 2016 - Feb 2017 Quality controller
VIBUMA.COM - VIETNAM BUILDING MATERIALS

2013 - 2018 BSc. Urban and Regional Planning
HO CHI MINH UNIVESITY OF ARCHITECTURE

Skill

Autodesk AutoCAD
Autodesk InfraWorks
Autodesk Civil 3D
Sketchup

Adobe Photoshop
Adobe Illustrator
Adobe Indesign

Lumion
QGIS
Handsketch

Microsoft Word
Microsoft Excel
Microsoft PowerPoint

Languages

Vietnamese

English

Dutch

Japanese

Mandarin

Whenever I update my portfolio, I feel deeply grateful for the journey I have been on.

As an urban planner, I have had many opportunities to work, learn, and grow alongside experts from various fields. Across all the projects I have contributed to, water has consistently played a major and important role, appearing in many forms and scales. As I continue my journey, I aim to further expand my knowledge in the fields of urbanism and landscape, especially as we face the realities of global warming.

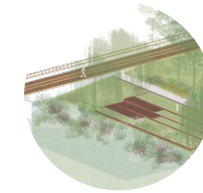


Selected projects are personal and academic work.
Professional work samples can be shared upon request via presentation or printed book,
respecting NDA constraints.

Selected works



ESTUARY POROSITY
3



COLENTINA LAKE
11



THE INTERACTION GRADIENT
13

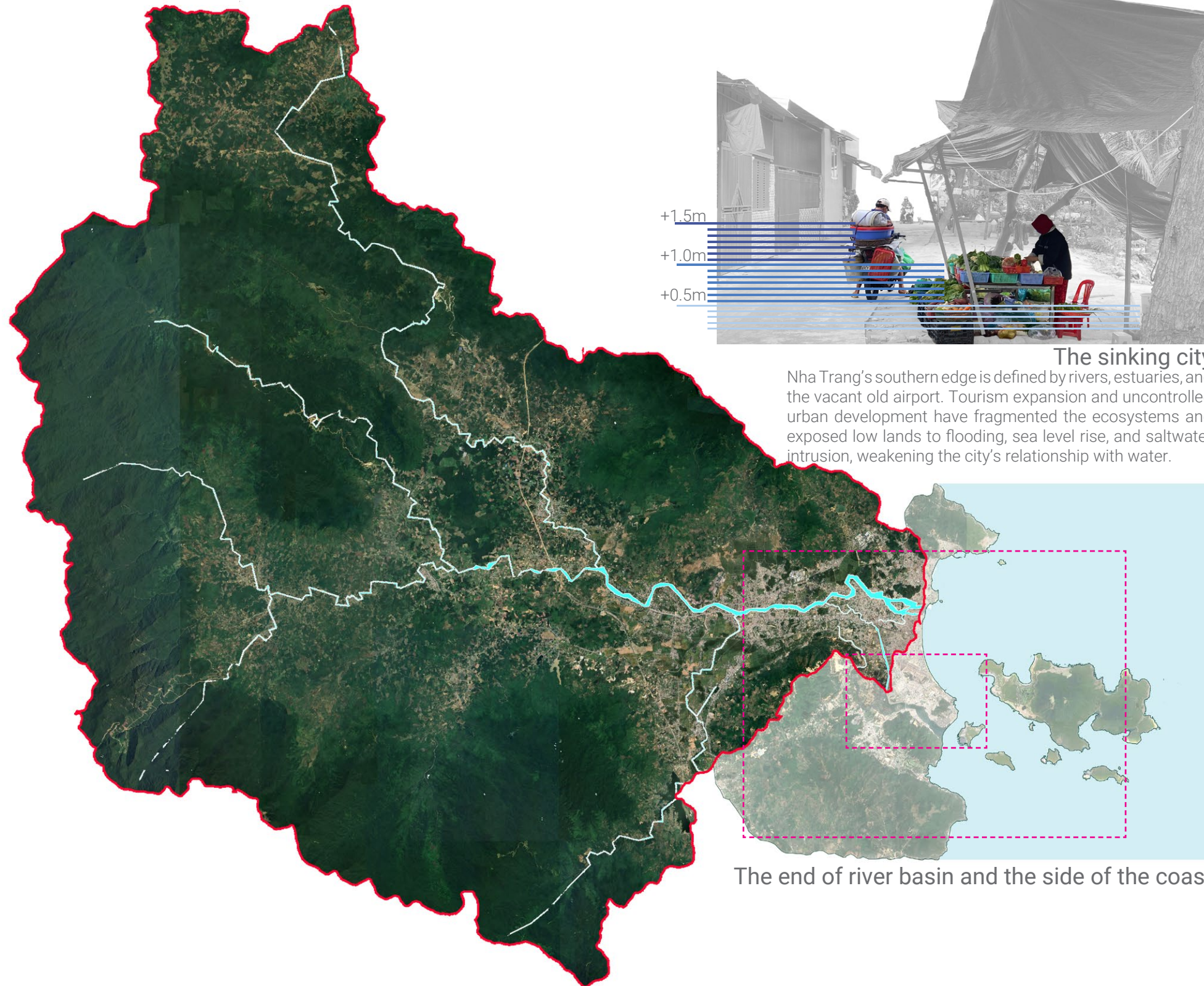


FOREST OF REMEDY
17



Cities located in low-lying coastal regions and river delta are heavily affected by global warming and sea-level rise. In addition, natural estuarine ecological environments have been disappearing throughout human history, first transformed into productive landscapes, and then later filled up to build cities.

This study reimagines the estuary as a living landscape. Seasonal wetlands, mangroves, and adaptive aquaculture form the ecological core, while elevated areas are utilized for dry landscape, public spaces, and new development.



The sinking city

Nha Trang's southern edge is defined by rivers, estuaries, and the vacant old airport. Tourism expansion and uncontrolled urban development have fragmented the ecosystems and exposed low lands to flooding, sea level rise, and saltwater intrusion, weakening the city's relationship with water.

The end of river basin and the side of the coast

Site study on 3 scales

General assessment



Focused study area



Fieldwork research

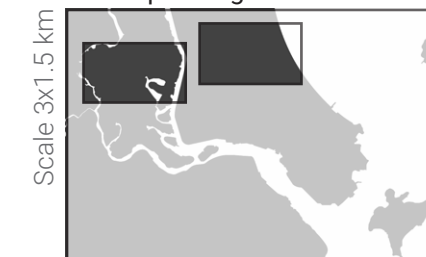


Proposal on 3 scales

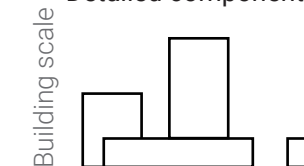
Landscape urbanism vision



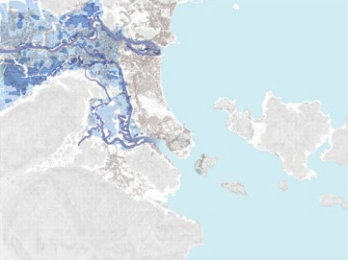
Development guidelines



Detailed components



Fluvial Flood risk



Sea level rise prediction



Saltwater intrusion in the dry season



Scale 24x18 km

The territory scale was used to analyze the most important problems and constraints of Nha Trang. Focusing on the coastal urban area, the city is affected not only by fluctuations from the rivers but also pressures from the sea.

1964



1983



2003



2024



Scale 9x6 km - Landscape Urbanism historical layers



To analyze deeper on the study area, four time points from 1964 to 2024 were selected using U.S. military maps and Google Earth imagery. Spaced at roughly two-decade intervals, these snapshots capture key phases of urban transformation. Historically, Nha Trang's growth remained concentrated around the old airport and beachfront, highlighting the gradual expansion of urban form into surrounding landscapes.

Mangrove

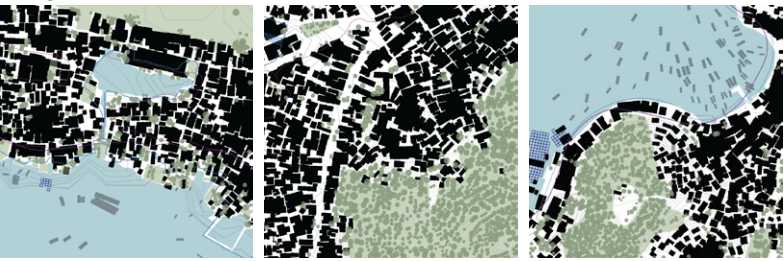
New agriculture

New aquaculture

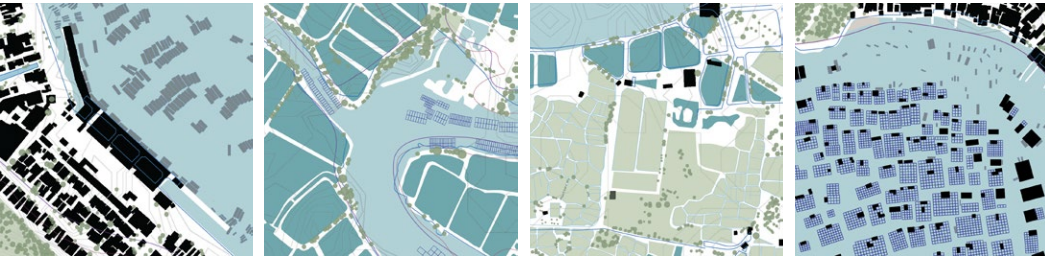
New buildings

Old buildings

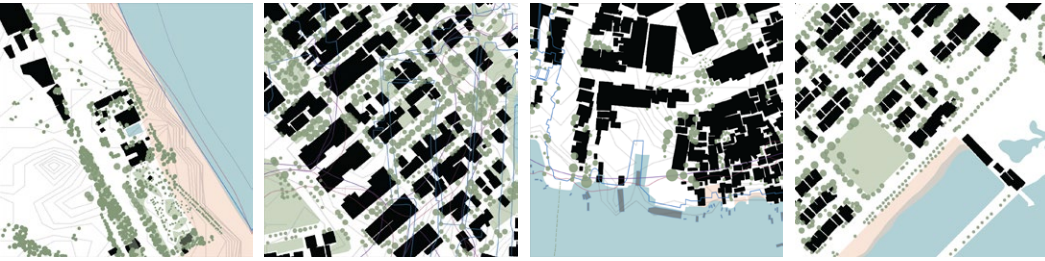
Indigenous settlements



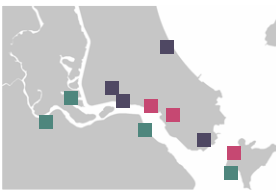
Productive landscapes



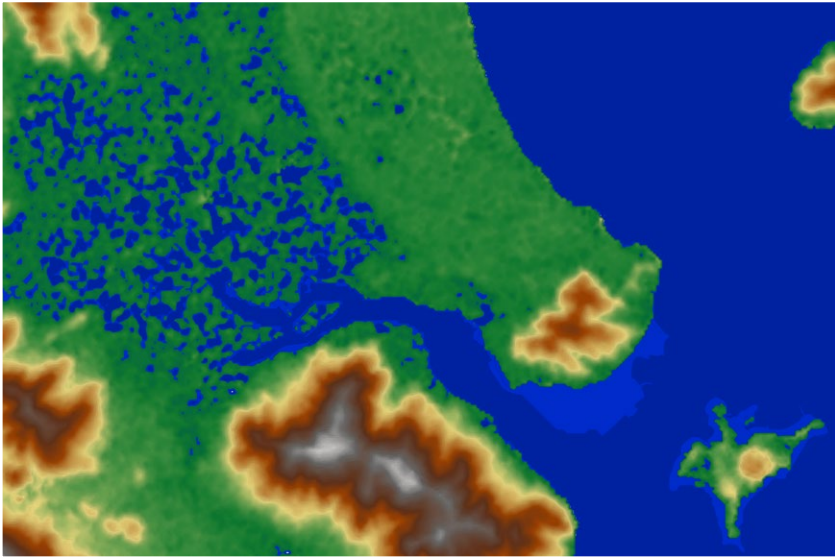
New urban fabric



Scale 400x400 m - Stamps of Urban Fabric

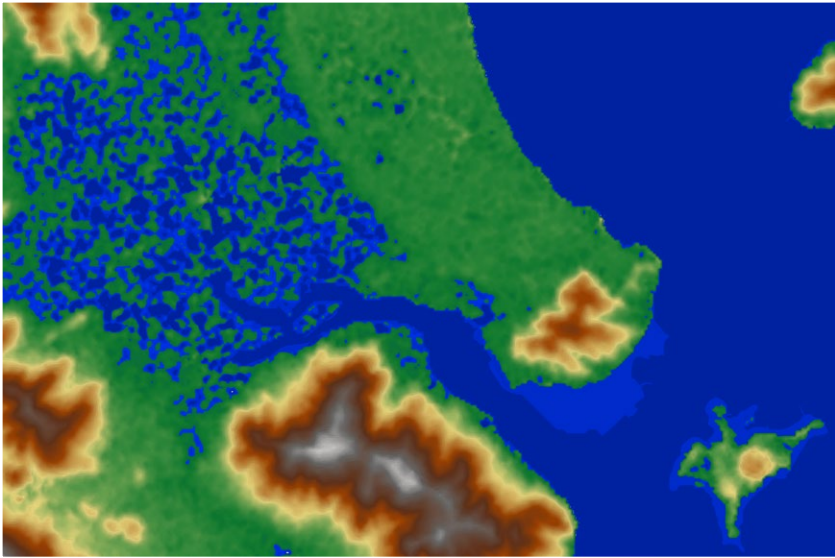


Fieldwork applied a sampling method using 400x400 meter squares to study the landscape urbanism on detail samples. Eleven sites were selected and grouped into three typologies: Indigenous settlements, Productive landscapes, and New urban fabric. This framework enabled comparative analysis, revealing how traditional communities, aquaculture zones, and emerging developments interact and transform over time.

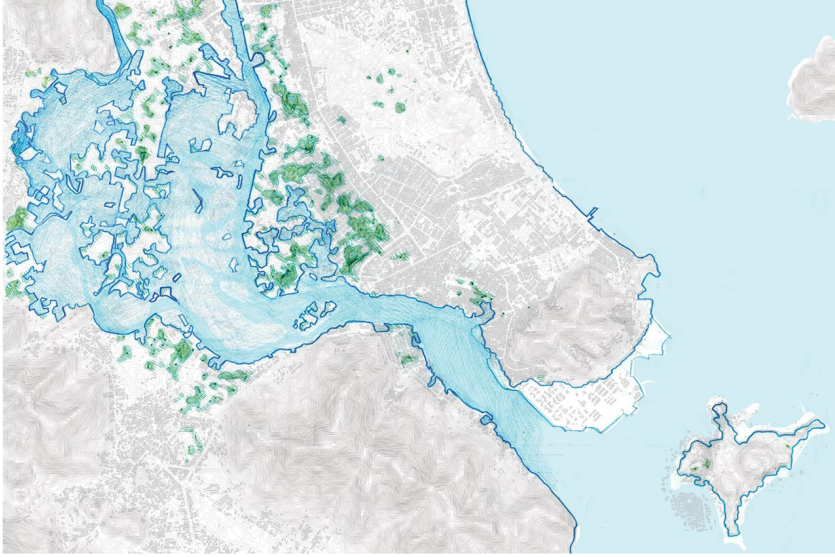


2100 - Sea level rise forecast (+1.0m)

The Vietnamese government's official forecast scenario projects a +1.0 m sea level rise for the site by 2100. On the other hand, under a high-impact extreme scenario, the sea level rise could reach up to +2.0 m.

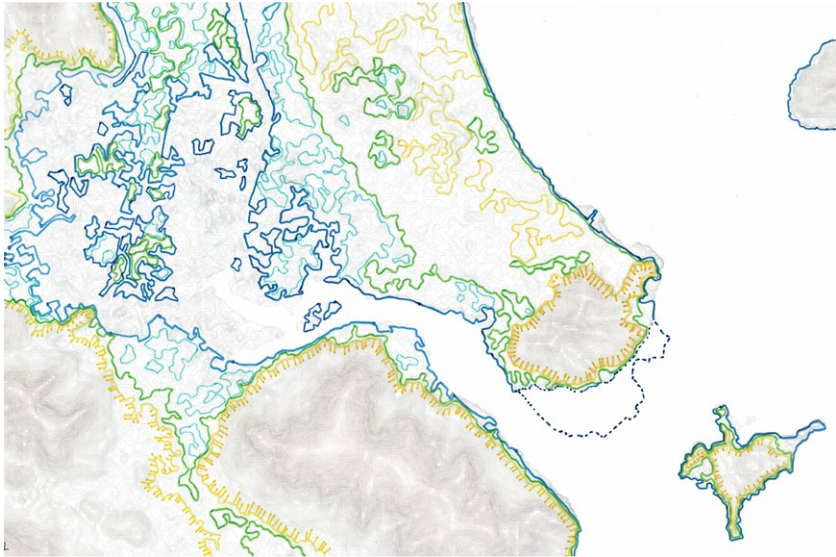
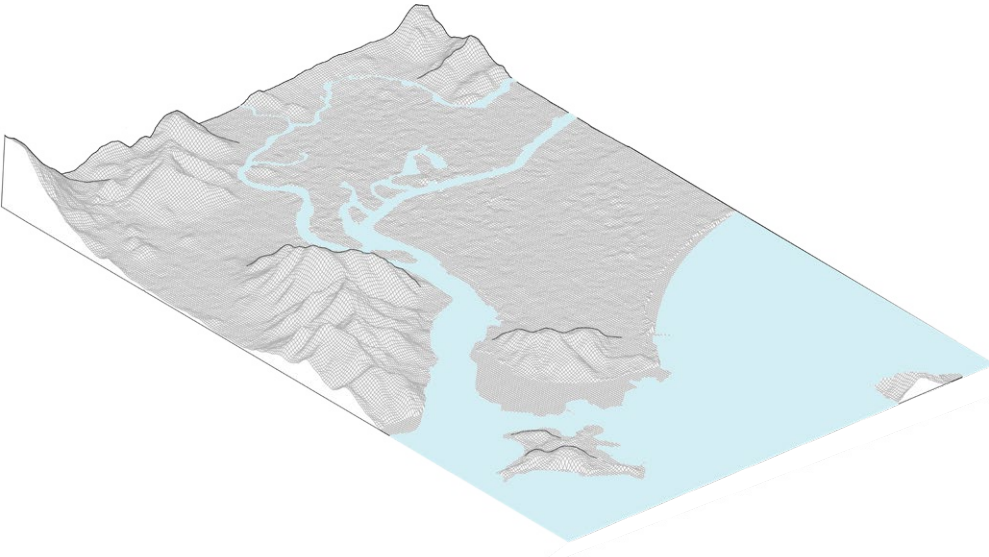


2100 - Sea level rise extreme scenario (+2.0m)



Sea level rise flood in 2100

The 2100 sea level rise flooding was mapped by combining the current water surface level for continuously inundated areas with potential flooding in low-lying areas across the site.



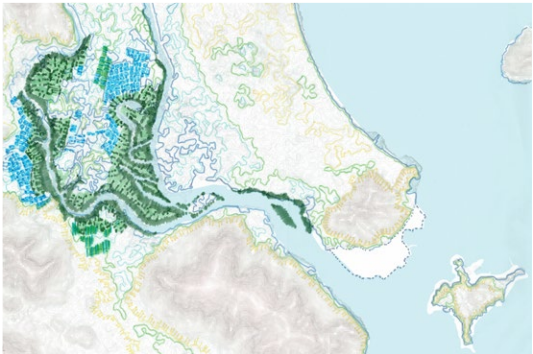
Identification of Buildable and non-Buildable areas

Buildable and non-buildable areas are defined by elevation and flood vulnerability. Combined with the existing urban fabric, these zones establish a spatial system of city edges and high-lying 'islands'.



The system of edges & islands

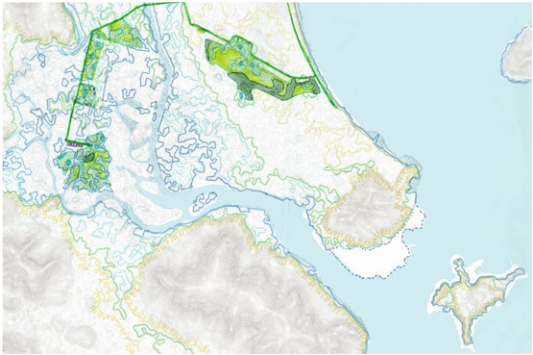
The vision use landscape as the guildline for uran expansion. It begins with re-naturalize key ecological elements of the estuary, such as mangroves patches and wet-lands.



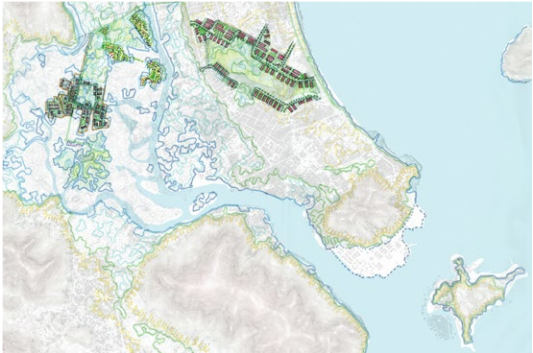
Re-naturalize the estuary



Re-naturalize the South river front



Re-naturalize the low land



Weaving the city back to nature



Drought - Dry season



Flood - Rainy season



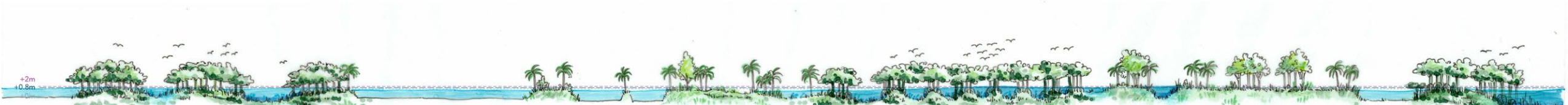
2100 - Extreme sea level rise scenario

1km

Urban vegetation and landscapes then following the principle of “low for water - high for activities”. Seasonal variation creates a dynamic landscape throughout the year, with long-term adaptability considered for changes projected by 2100. Urban elements follows the existing pattern of the city, then gradually blending with the landscape, taking advantage of higher ground to avoid flooding and sea-level rise.



Drought - Dry season



Flood - Rainy season

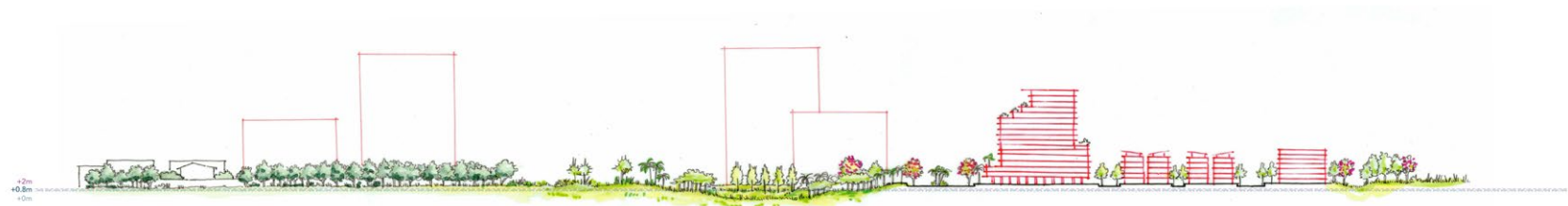


2100 - Extreme sea level rise scenario - Aerated lagoons turn into mangroves

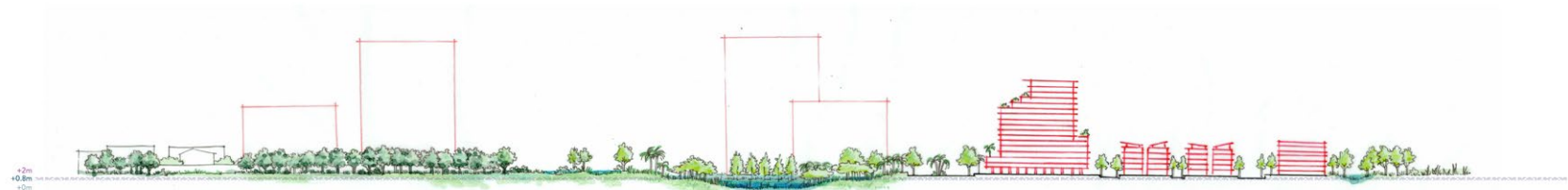
0 200 400m 1km



0 200 400m 1km



Drought - Dry season



Flood - Rainy season

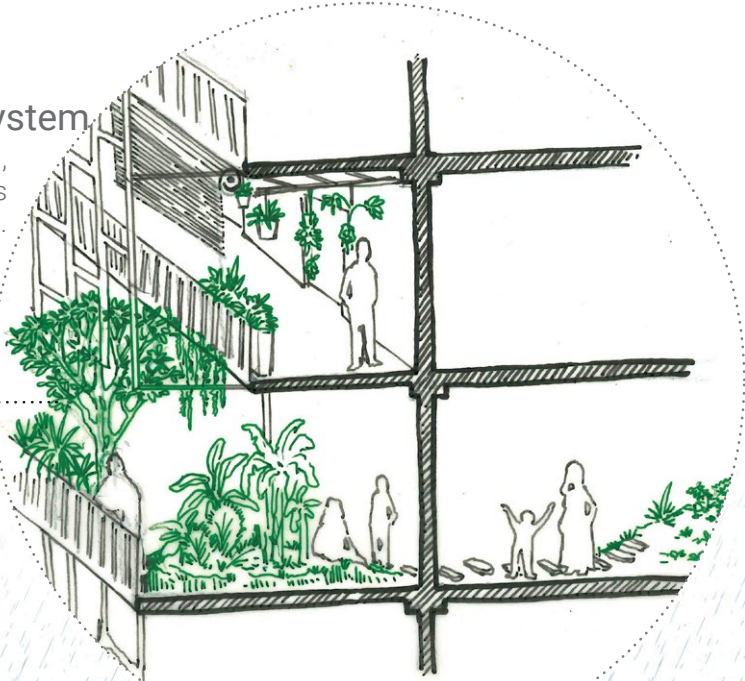


Scale 3x1.5 km - Development guidelines - In the heart of the city

The central open space of the former airport, with its varied elevations, is transformed into seasonal wetlands by excavating lower areas, creating a water-based landscape that serves both existing and new urban fabric in South Nha Trang. The urban system is organized into two typologies: Urban Edge and Bridge to Landscape. Near existing developments, new construction adapts to the current fabric, while building blocks along the former runway are arranged perpendicular to the main axis, forming channels that guide movement and visual connection toward the central wetland park.

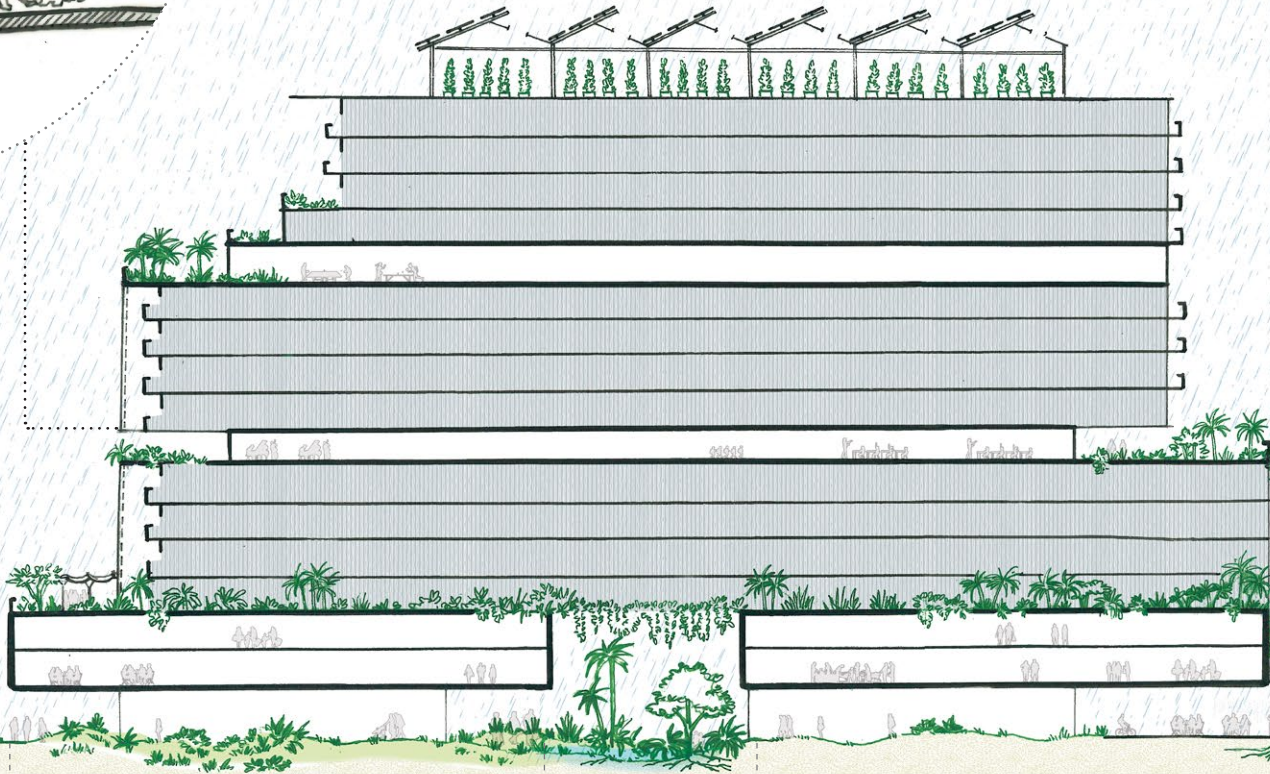
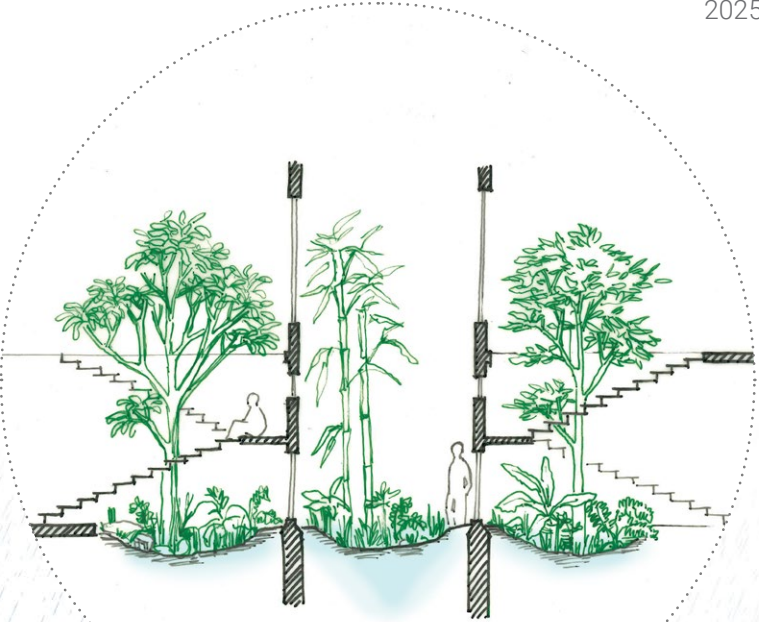
Dual-layer shading system

Dual-layer shading system, including operable louvers and curtains facing the west.



Shared technical corridor for water run off

Shared technical corridor running behind low-rise units as green infrastructure spine. This space collects rainwater, facilitates natural infiltration and groundwater recharges through reverse osmosis.



Seasonal wetlands

Permanent drylands

Road with Permeable sidewalk and Swale

Cycling lane

Permeable courtyard

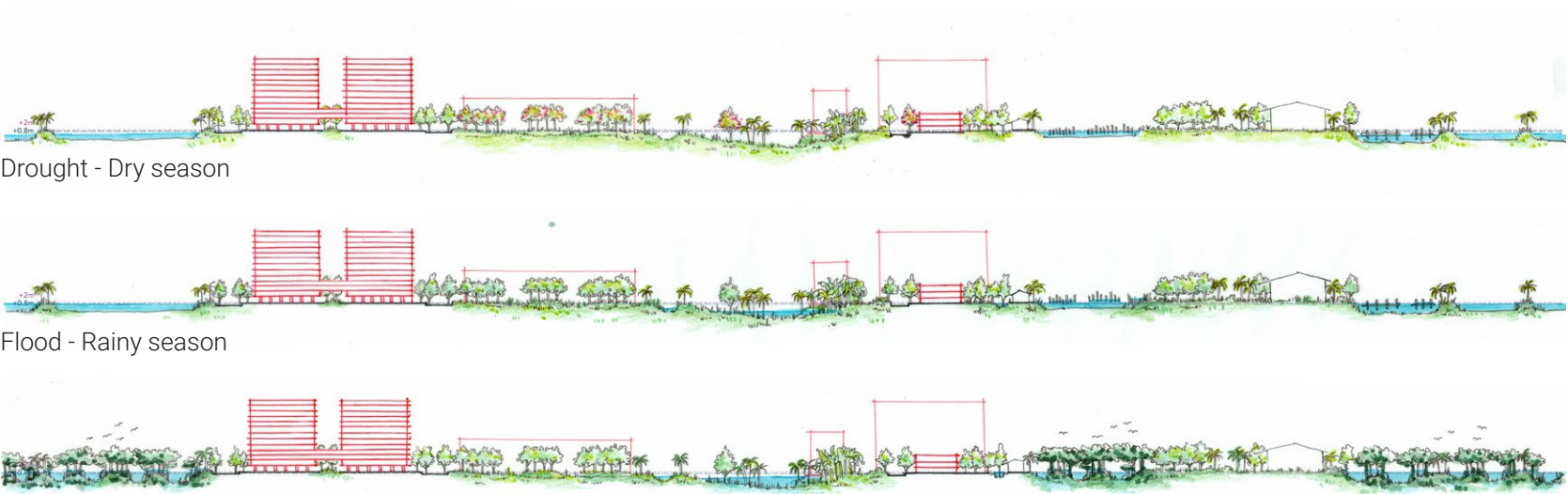
Road with Permeable sidewalk and Swale

Technical corridor

A section through buildings at the heart of the city - The new city's edge

Mid- and high-rise blocks in higher density of the city feature partially open ground floors, creating covered passageways that connect urban spaces with landscapes and are planted with shade-tolerant shrubs to enhance biodiversity and microclimate. Rooftops host lightweight greenhouse hydroponics for local food production. Sidewalks integrate vegetated swales that enhance aesthetics, retain surface water during the rainy season, and gradually recharge groundwater.

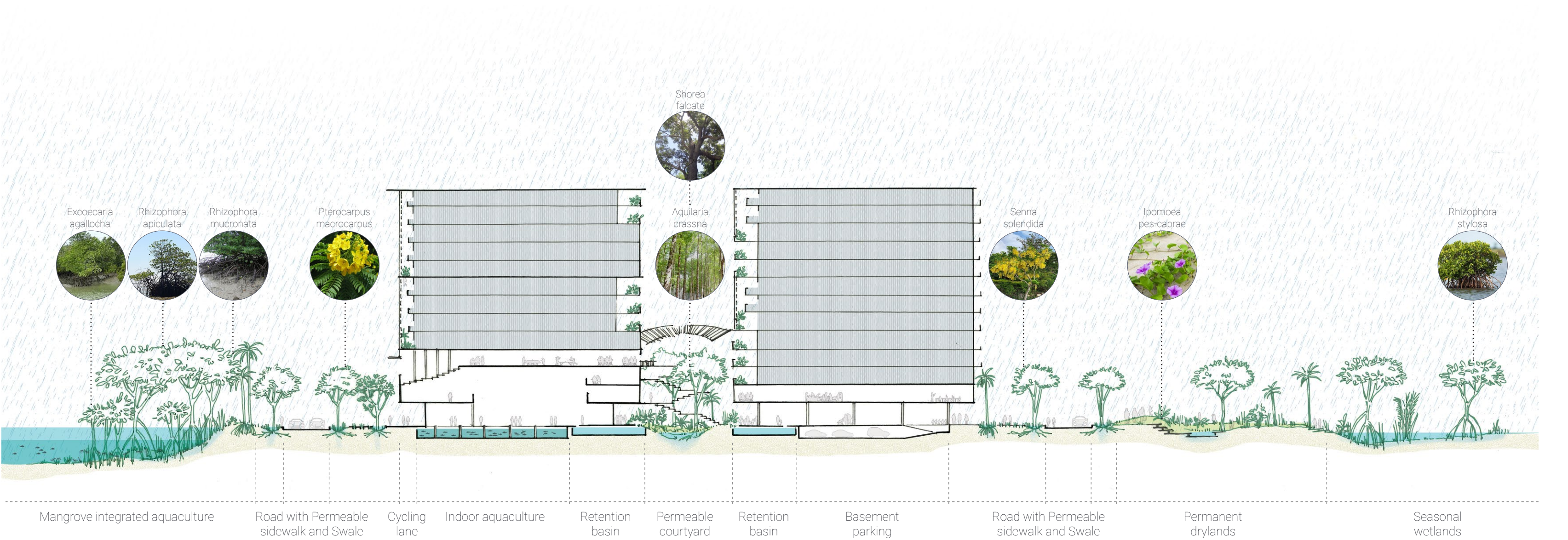




2100 - Extreme sea level rise scenario - Aerated lagoons turn into mangroves



Scale 3x1.5 km - Development guidelines - Islands of productive landscape
For new developments at existing productive landscape area, permanent and seasonal wetlands follow similar design principles, with part of the landscape park functioning as a natural filtration zone using wetland vegetation. Captured water is reused for agriculture or irrigation in adjacent parks. Seasonal wetlands connect directly to rivers, allowing excess water to discharge during heavy rainfall. Built elements are closely integrated with productive landscapes, sometimes extending them through new functions such as indoor aquaculture ponds.



A section through buildings on the islands on wetland - Living in between water and forest

Mid- and high-rise blocks in this area can be integrated with indoor aquaculture near productive landscapes, supporting stable, controlled cultivation. Located in the estuarine zone and prone to flooding, these buildings incorporate water retention basins within internal courtyards to manage pluvial, fluvial, and sea level fluctuations. Excess water is temporarily stored and gradually recharged into the soil, enhancing resilience while maintaining functional and ecological integration with the surrounding landscape.



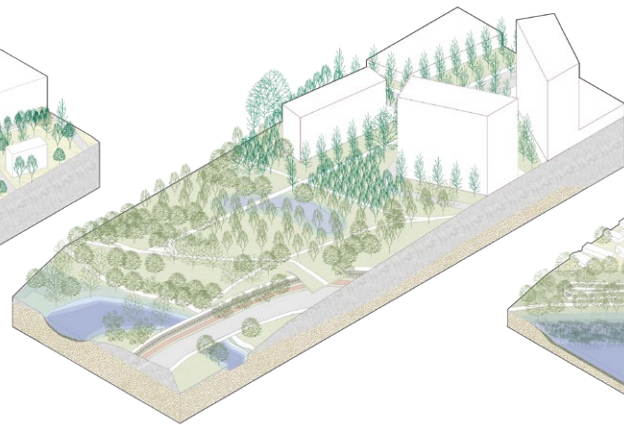
COLENTINA LAKE INTERNATIONAL COMPETITION

Location: Bucharest, Romania
Summer Internship 2024
Company: Metapolis

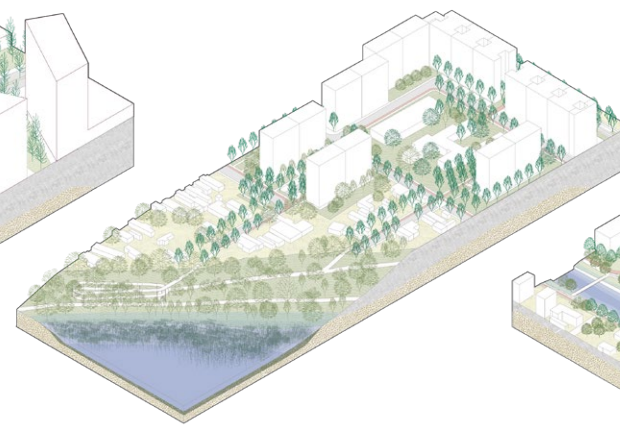
The competition site is located within the Colentina lakes system, featuring diverse landscapes between the water bodies and urban development. The following selections showcase 10 key areas selected within the competition site. These are examples to show how the landscape and urban interventions can enhance both the waterfront environment and its overall quality. The urban design emphasizes the creation of public spaces along the waterfront while integrating new layers of vegetation to enrich the landscape.



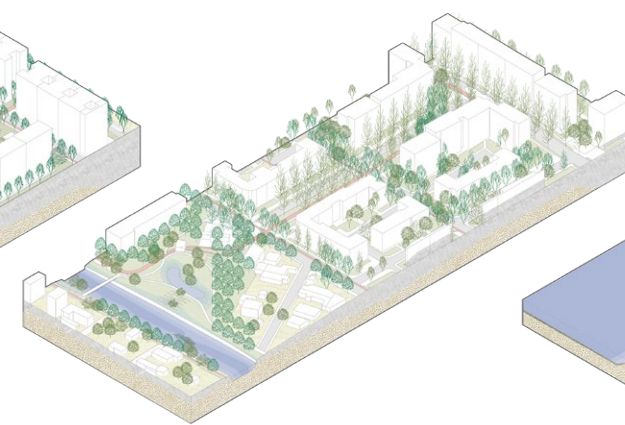
Central and private office blocks



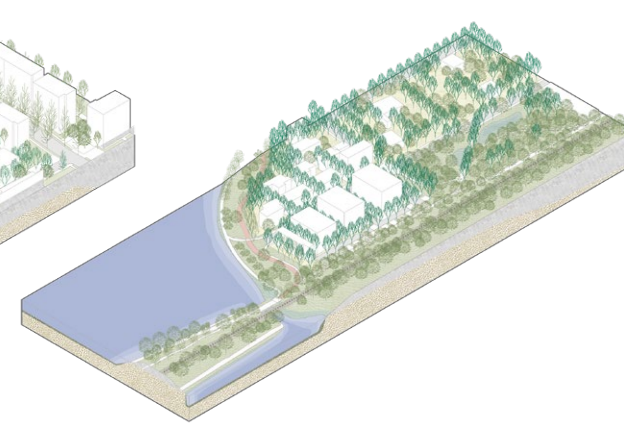
High-rise commercial and residential blocks - late 2010



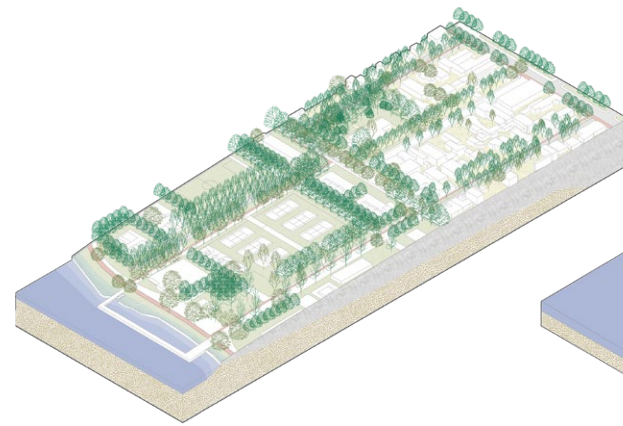
Communism residential blocks (70s) and low-rise residences



Mid-rise residences



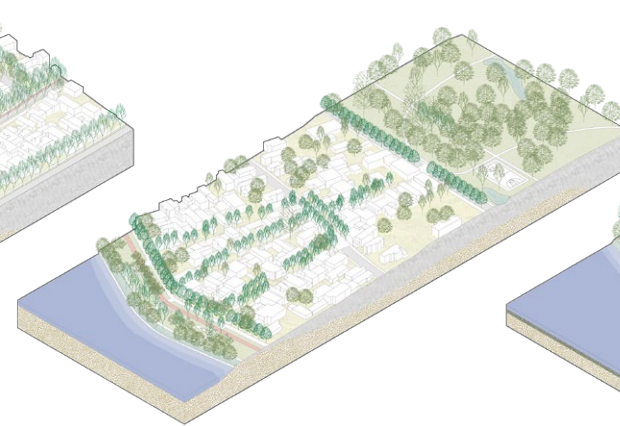
Public facility blocks



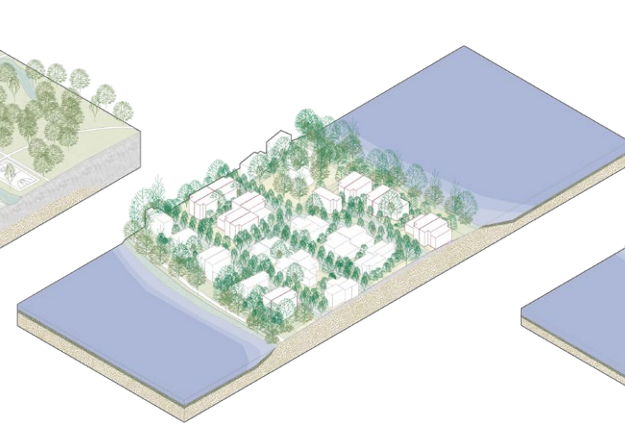
Low-rise mid density residences and waterfront public sport facility.



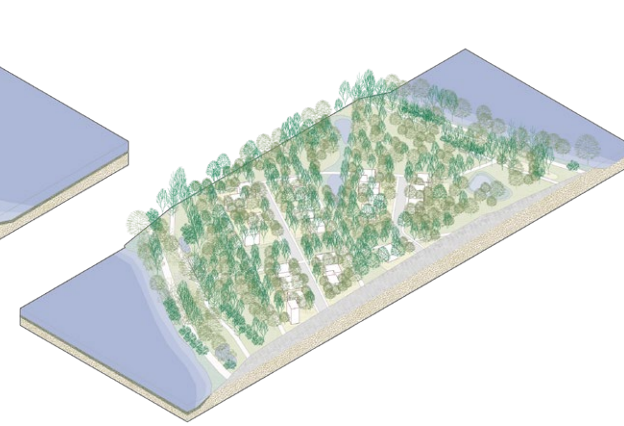
Low-rise and high density residences and low density commercial blocks



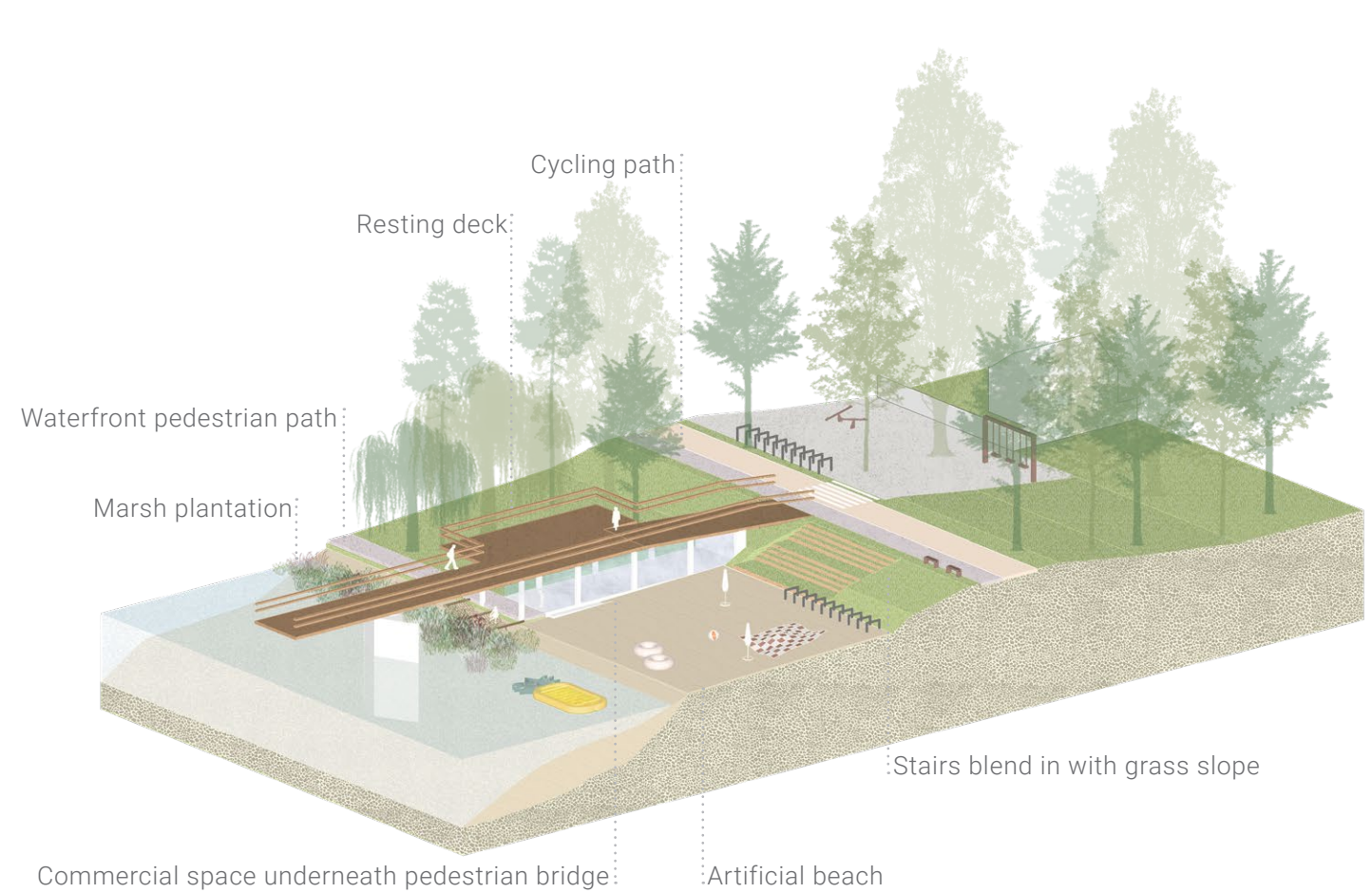
Low-rise and high density residences



Low-rise and mid density residences

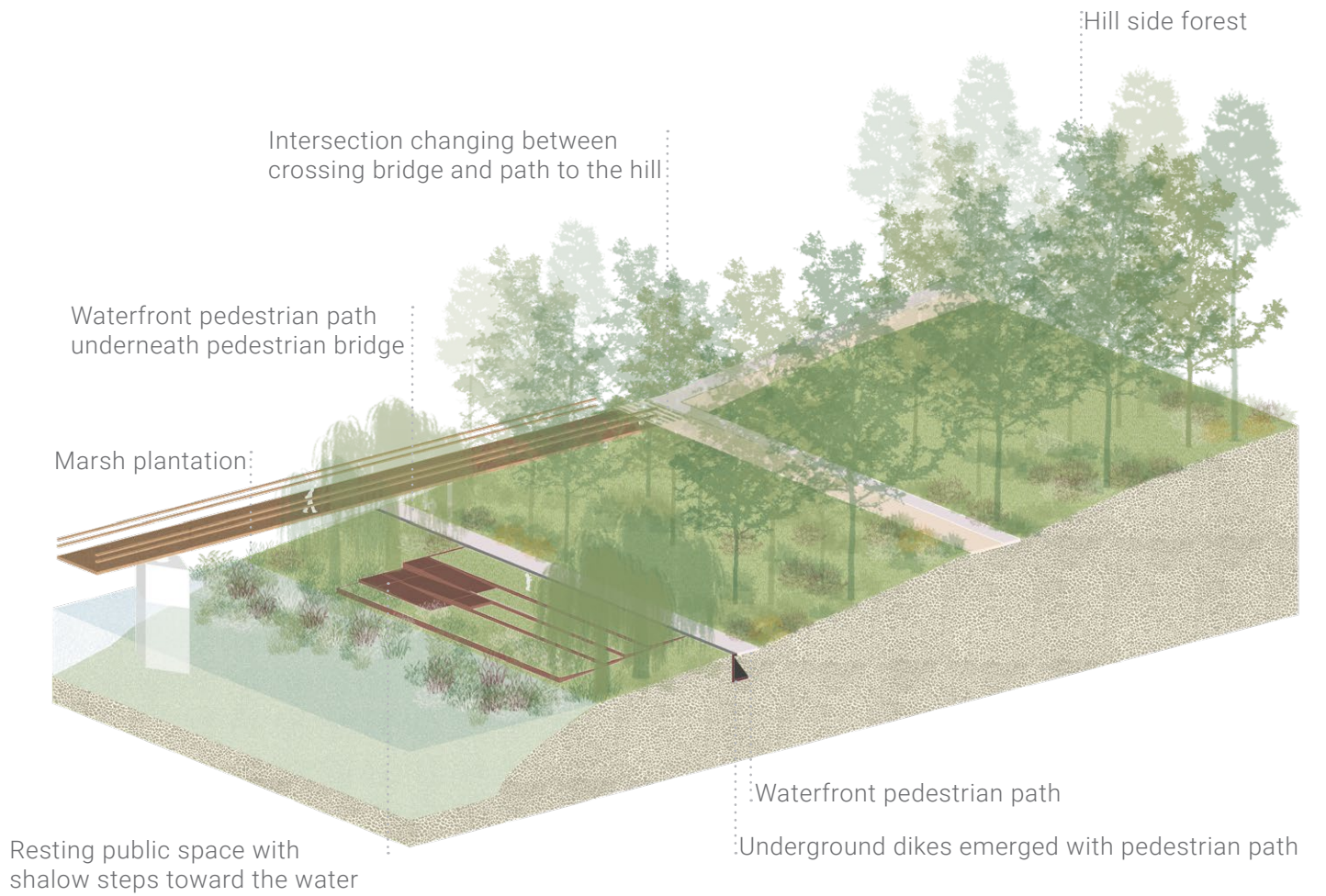


Low-rise and low density residences



Pedestrian bridge with artificial beach
Urban design example cut

Artificial beaches are located in closed-curve areas - with less impact from water currents - to provide a diverse open-space landscape. In narrower sections of the lakes system, pedestrian bridges are developed to connect pedestrians and cyclists throughout the city. This provides an efficient connection, without interference from cars and trucks. The spaces beneath the bridge slopes can serve as public spaces or commercial areas, contributing to the local economy.



Pedestrian bridge connects directly to the hill
Urban design example cut

The waterfront at the natural foothill requires more protection against erosion. An underground dike system is embedded into pedestrian path to strengthen the shoreline while maintaining the connection between the water and surrounding landscapes. The waterfront public spaces in more protected area focus on providing quiet, restful environments that are immersed in nature.



THE GRADIENT BETWEEN VALLEY AND TERRACE

Location: Brussels, Belgium
Master Studio 2024

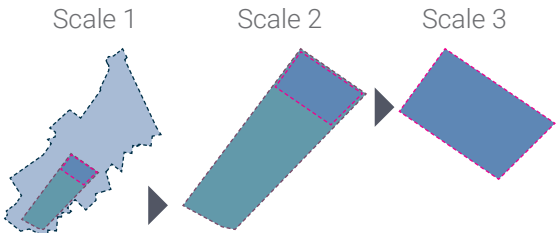
The south of Brussel is dominated by industrial and productive functions. These spaces often distance themselves from ecological and environmental aspects, especially when it comes to creating integrated, high-quality living spaces.

To break away from the traditional mono-functional planning, where industrial and logistics dominate a single area, the project's goal was to explore new ways of integrating residential and public spaces into industrial zones, which are often seen as the city's backstage.



Three scales of design

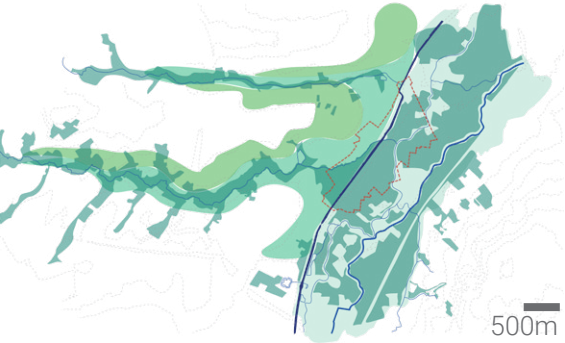
The project unfolded across three scales. Began with a broad territorial vision, then shifted to the development of a specific site, and ultimately zoomed into detailed spaces to reveal how the reconnect with individual users.



Three scales of design

Problem statement

The site - located in Biestebroek, Brussels, is historically connected to a broader valley system. This area faces challenges in revitalizing living spaces situated between industrial activities and degraded nartural environment.



The historical valley system

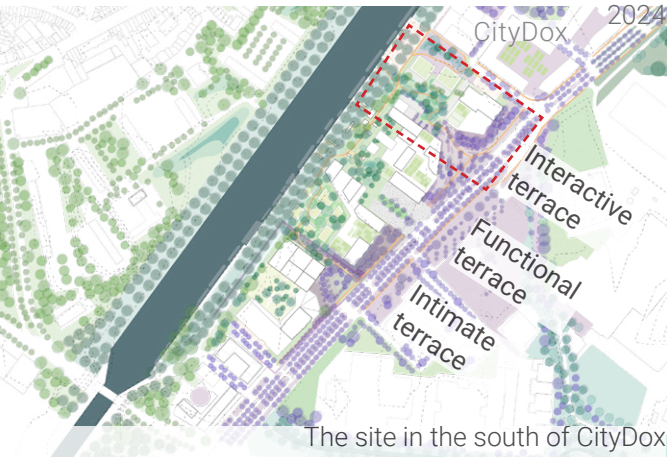


The vegetation system

Scale 3 - Individual work

The interactive space between productivities and public open space

The site in the south of CityDox reacts between 'existing fabric', the 'canal' and the 'boulevard'. As an extension of productive programs (factory, industry), the proposal aims to celebrate the production activities – which normavly be seen as backstage, by promoting the interaction between humans and nature.

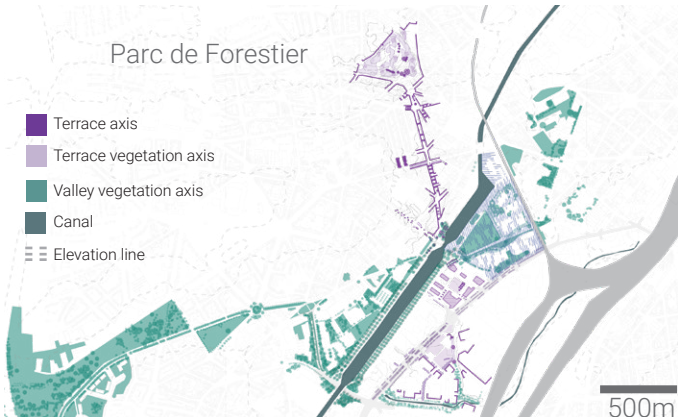


The site in the south of CityDox

Approach and Vision - Scale 1 and 2 - Groupwork of 4

Scale 1

Define 2 systems of landscape urbanism axes running through the site. The position of the new buildings follows the shape of open landscape systems.



The connection between the valley axis (natural environment) and the terrace axis (humans' activities)

Scale 2

Weave the character of both axes into the site. The project's main vision is to create a harmonious relationship between natural anviroment and human activities in the area south of CityDox, establishing a unified identity that blends their unique characteristics.



Open space landscape presents as the valley axis and building facade presents as the terrace axis

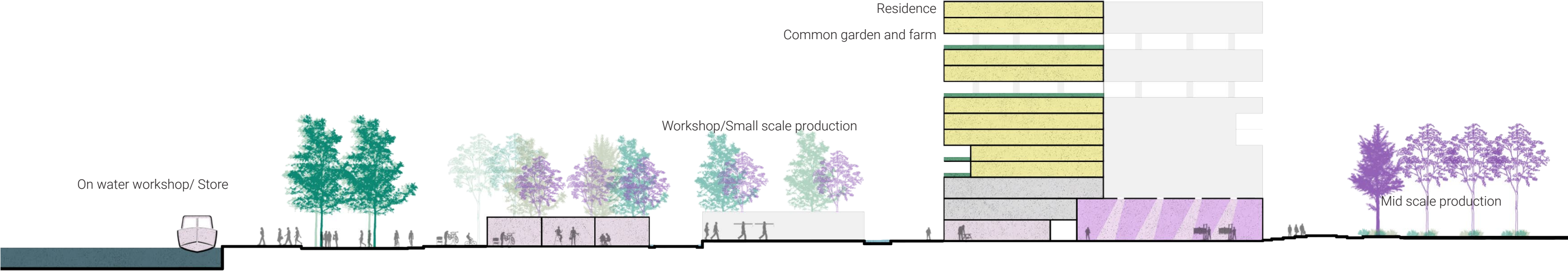


Axo view for vision scale 1

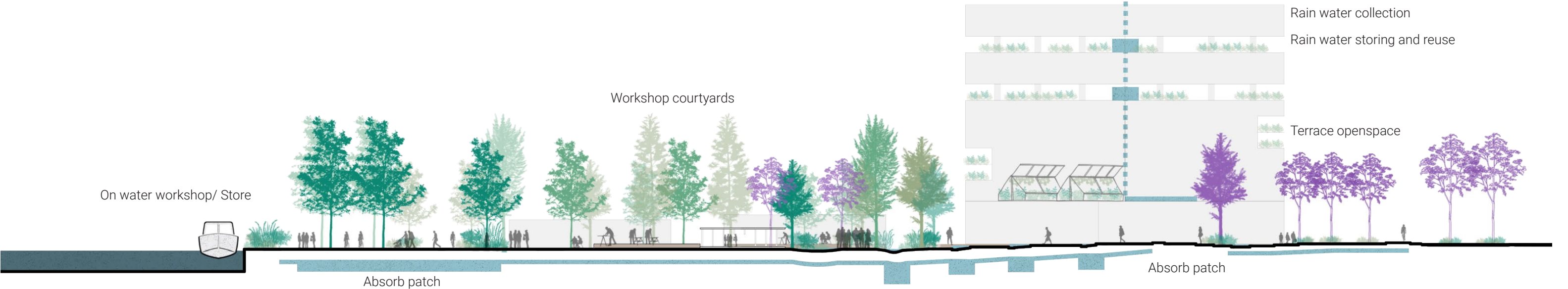


Axo view for scale 2





The journey of productivities from the boulevard to the canal - Section B-B



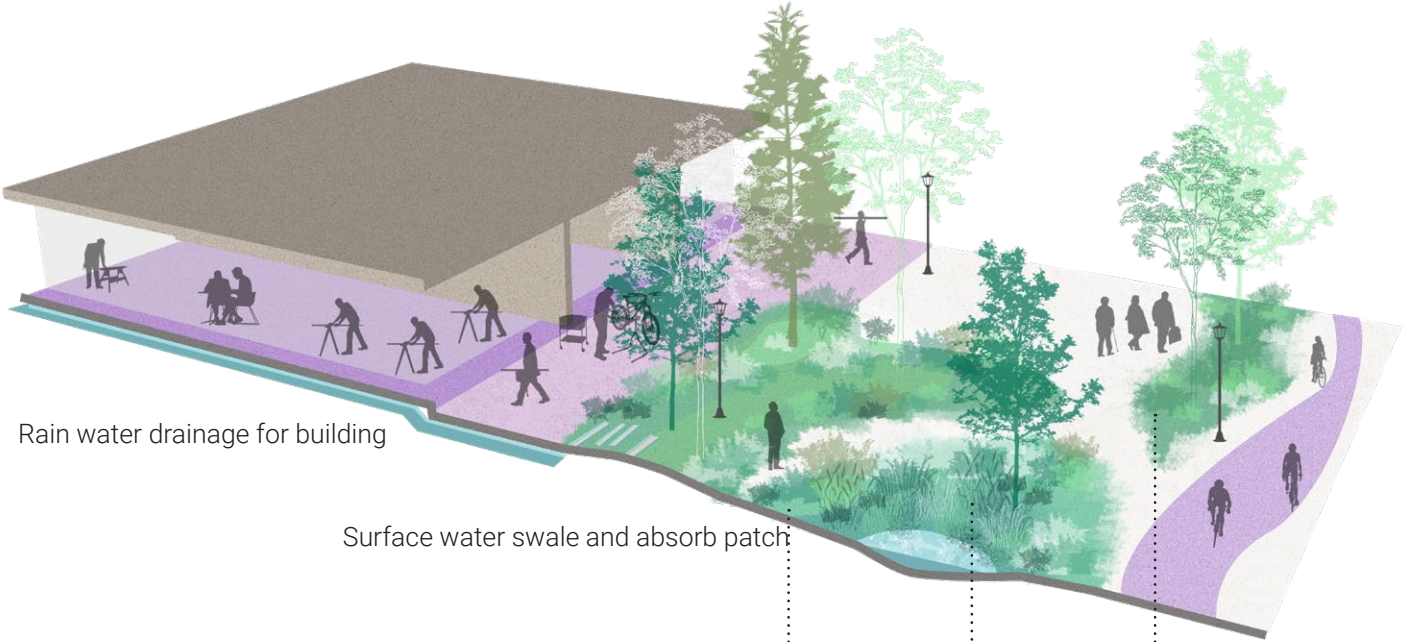
The journey of water and open space from the terrace to the valley axis - Section C-C



The transition from impermeable to permeable
Using the space with different functions at different times

A gradual shift is proposed, from impermeable built fabric and courtyards to permeable space with swales, wetlands, and vegetation. This creates opportunities to activate open spaces throughout different times of the day and seasons. By blending productive functions into the valley, the proposal aims to find a new way of living with nature, without overlooking our necessities.

Day time



Rain water drainage for building

Surface water swale and absorb patch



Phragmites australis



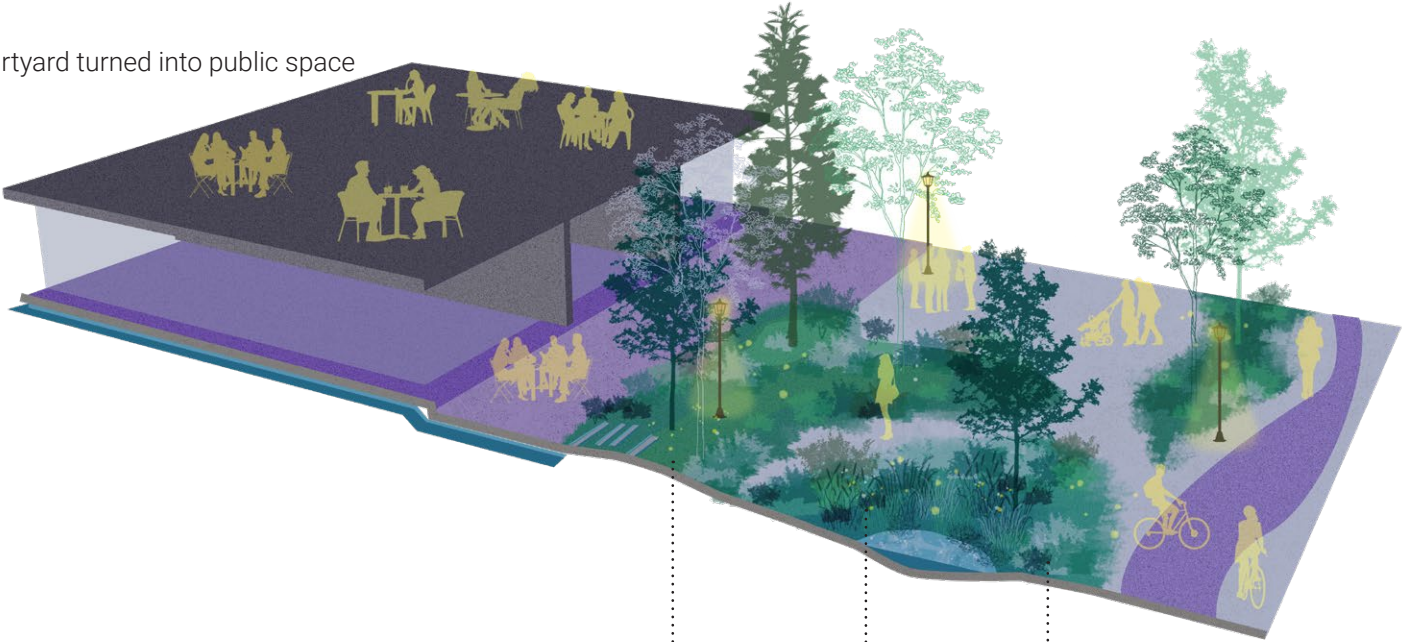
Iris pseudacorus



Carex riparia

Night time

Workshop courtyard turned into public space



Salix alba



Salix viminalis



Corydalis solida



THE CAMPUS FOREST FOREST OF REMEDY

Location: Leuven, Belgium
Master Studio 2023

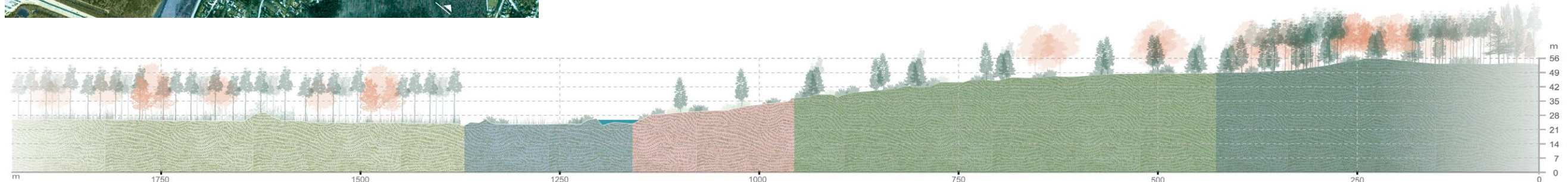
The city of Leuven - a home to many universities - has evolved into a 'Univercity', a large functioning campus that coexists with residential life. During the expansion of the campus around Arenberg Castle, a significant portion of forest was converted into built space. Although the forest is now protected and preserved, the design goal on this site was to bring back part of the forest while continuing to develop new student and staff housing within the existing low-rise campus.



The forest system

The site located in Heverleebos-Leuven, is surrounded by a various forests system, starting from the hill forest, then the garden forest, and toward the valley, are the water and marsh forests. The site lies at a connecting corridor between these systems and serves as the campus forest.

- Marsh forest
- Water forest
- Campus forest
- Garden forest
- Hill forest



The terrace of forests



Existing vegetation

- Accessible Grass Clearing
- Inaccessible Grassland
- Vegetation Barriers
- Existing Trees
- Dense Trees along the River
- Dense Grassland along the River
- Marshland
- Marshland with dense Trees
- Existing Buildings



Action plan

- Existing impermeable
- Kept buildings
- Demolished buildings
- New footprints

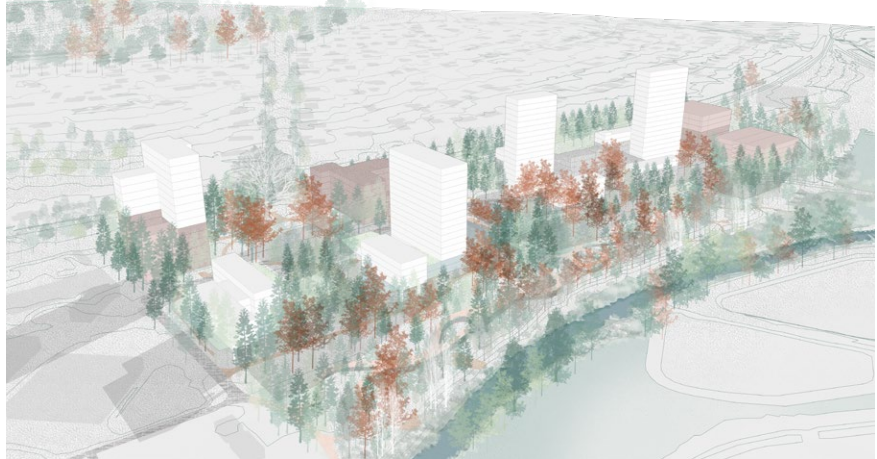
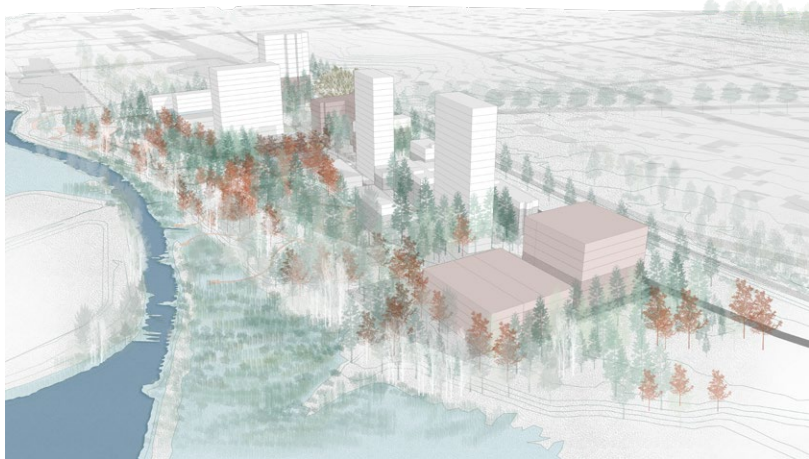
Approach and Vision - Groupwork of 3

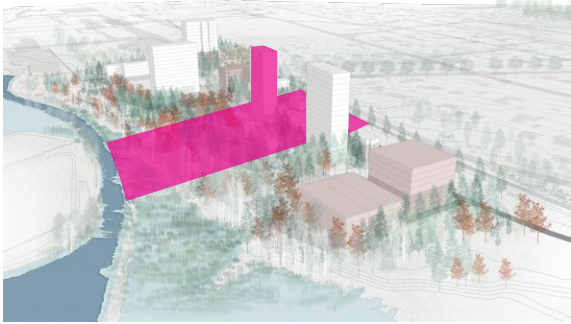
Bring the forest back through the campus forest

The design focuses on reintroducing pine and maple forest patches of varying density, from thin to thick, while promoting the relationship with the river through a diverse mix of vegetation. By embracing the seasonality and nobility of the forests, the interventions advocate a return to our fundamental connection with nature, encouraging urban form to shift in ways that allow forests to reclaim space.



The site between spring and autumn season

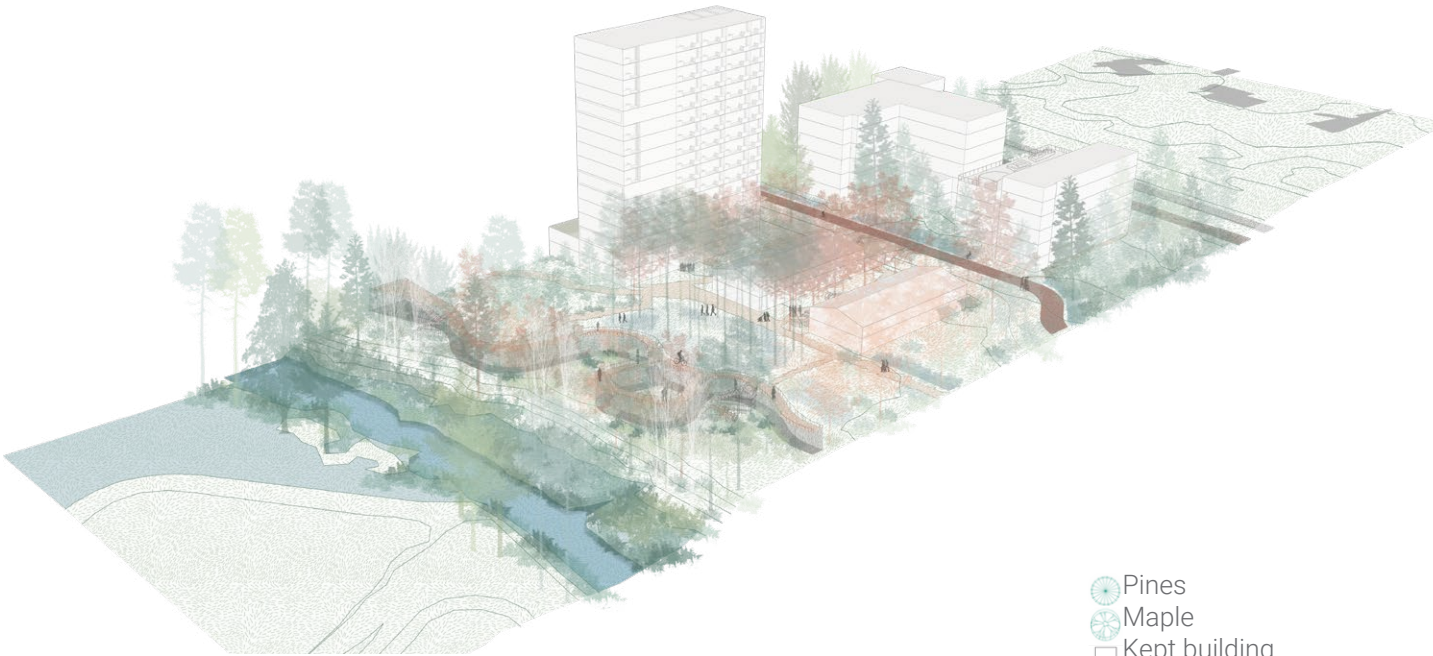




Forest of Remedy - Individual work

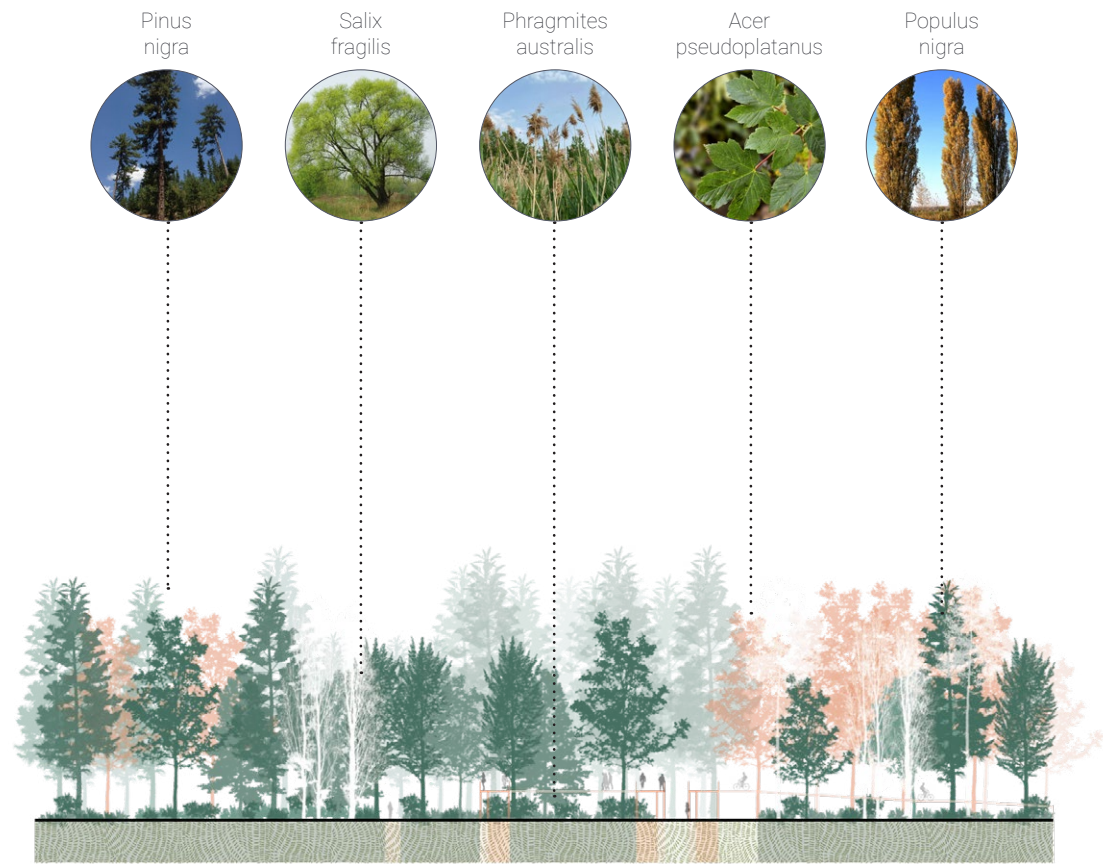
The forest for healing

Healing in the foest takes many forms for humans: strolling on the elevated lane through the branches, meditation walks under the high canopies or sitting in the pods among the quiet seasonal alley garden...
 It is also the healing spaces for the forest, where lights are turned away for its peaceful sleep at night, and water is being kept for the roots to thrive.



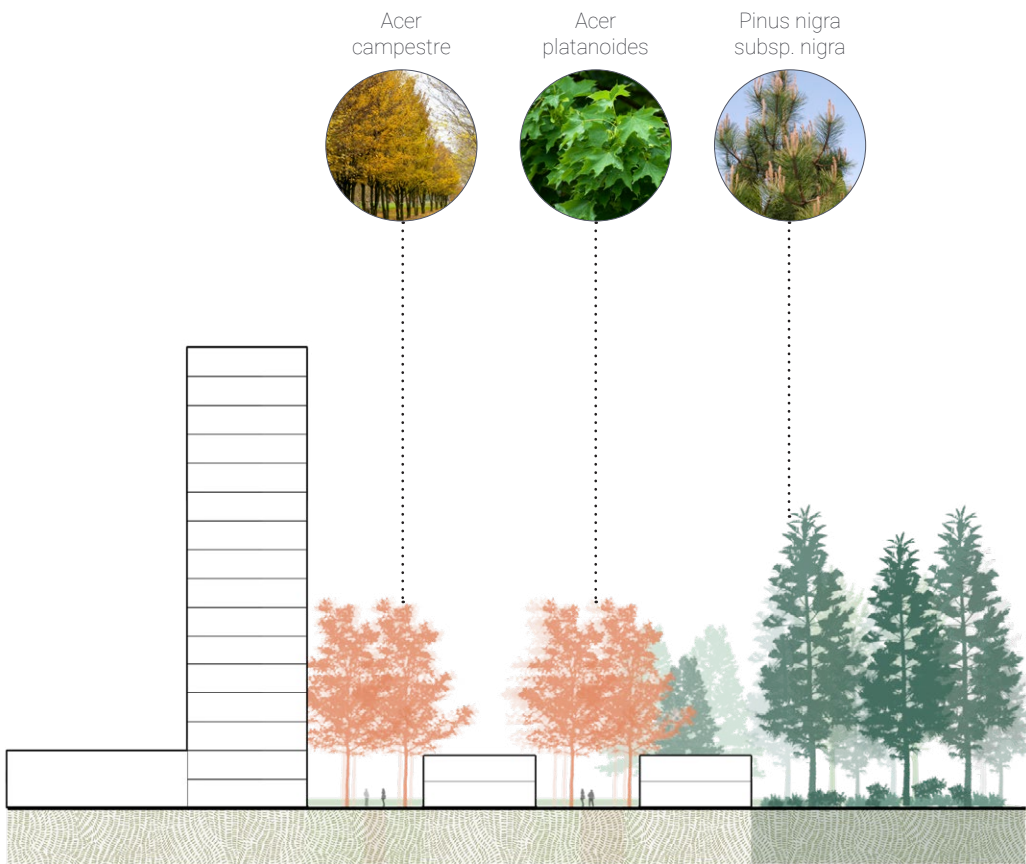
- Pines
- Maple
- Kept building
- Proposed building
- Grass slope
- Elevated metal net lane
- Walk-cycle soil trail
- Cycle cobble trail
- Sitting pod
- Low bushes
- Dense low vegetation



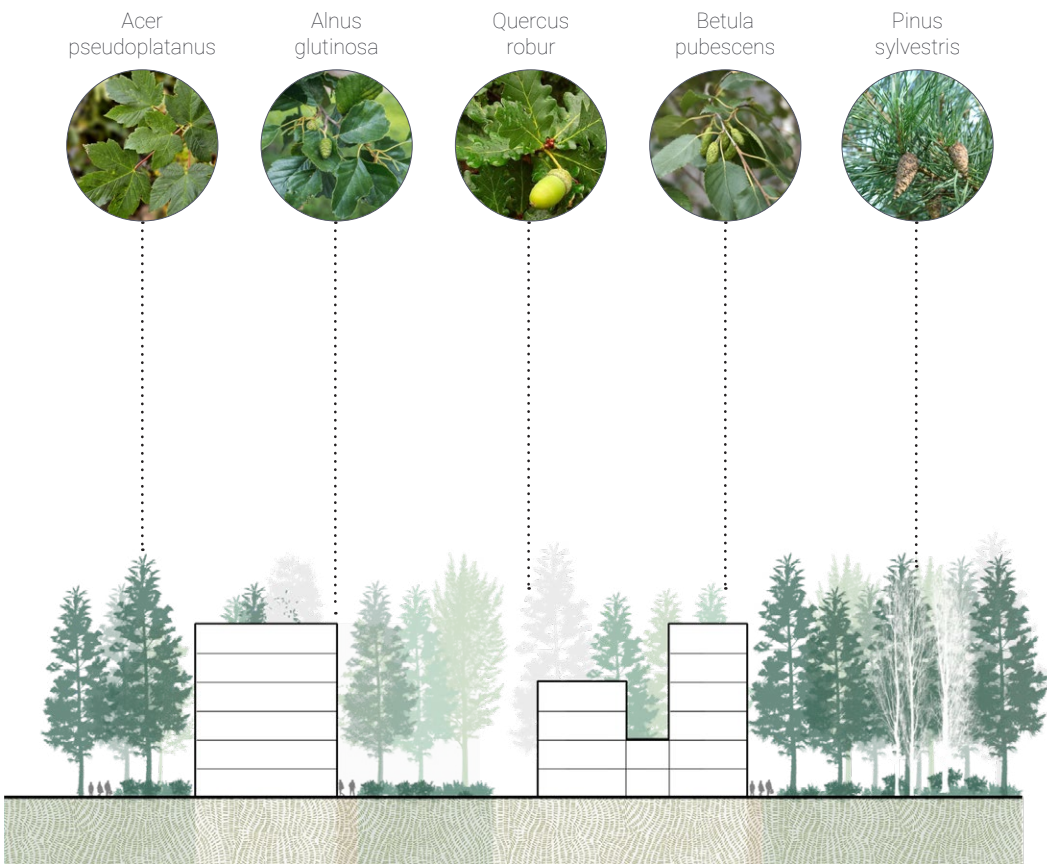


The section through Forest and Garden
Near the water, the cycling path passes through varying densities of forests and gardens.

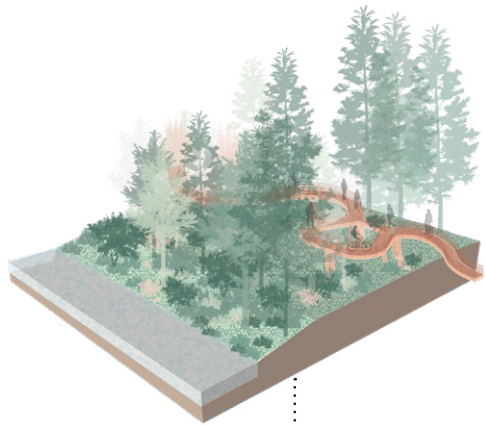
The Rythm of forest - garden - building through each slice



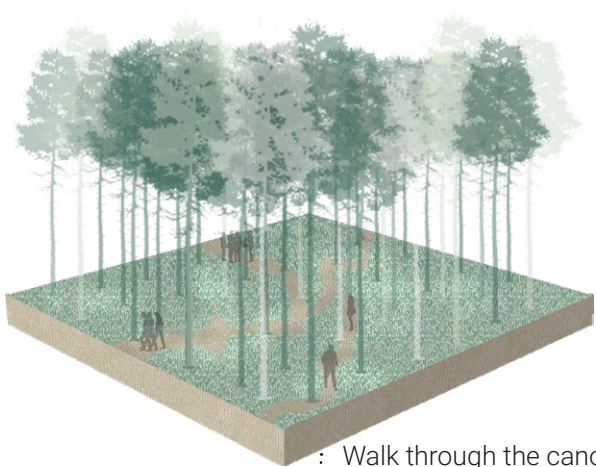
The section through Building and Garden
The residences and public facilities are located in between the gardens.



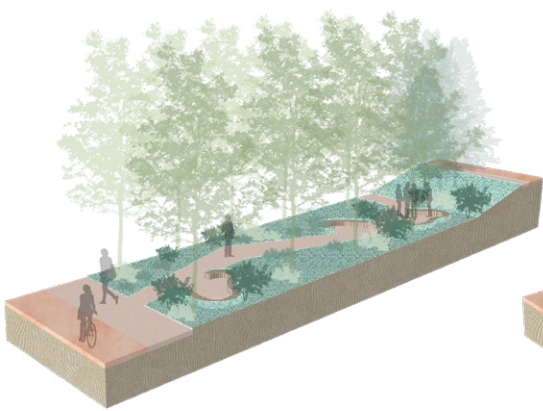
The section through Building and Forest
Offices, classrooms, and staff housing are intergrated into the forest setting.



Elevated cycling lane



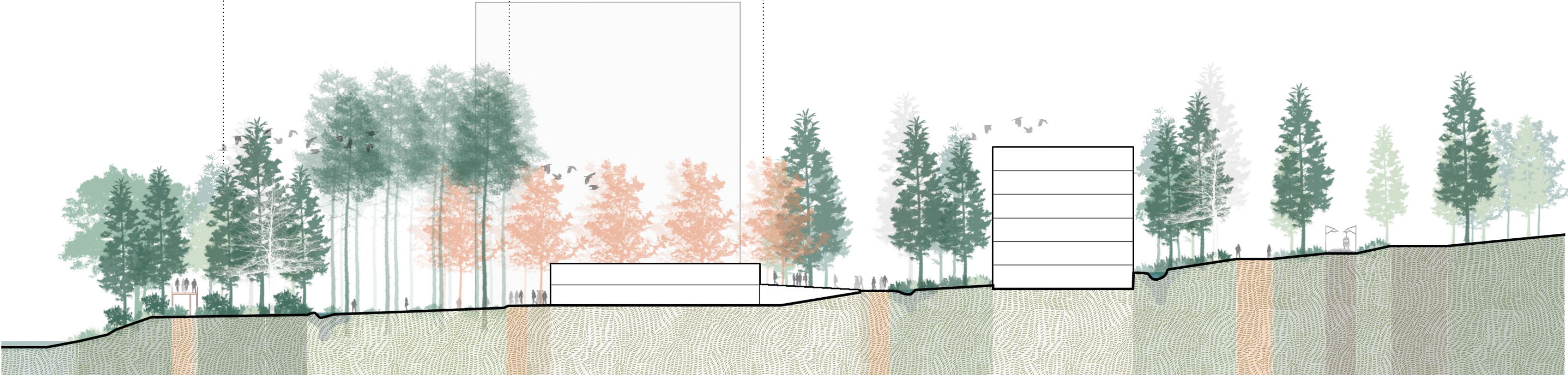
Walk through the canopy



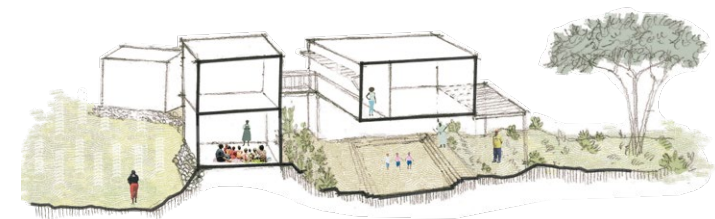
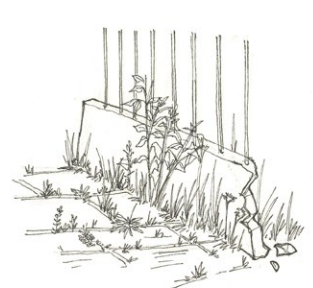
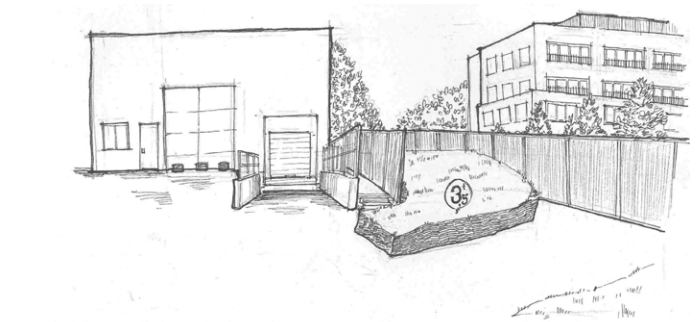
Garden of colors: Summer-Autumn

Different atmospheres of landscape

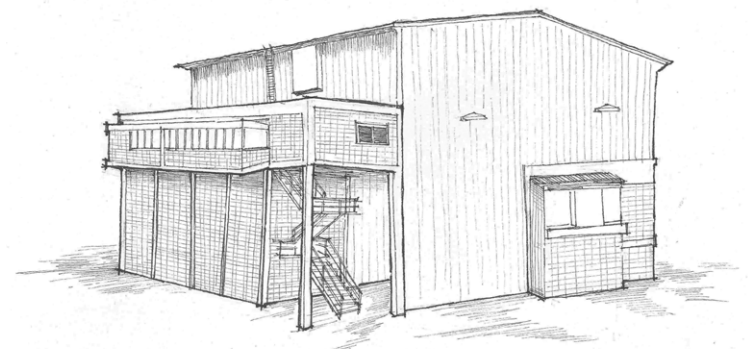
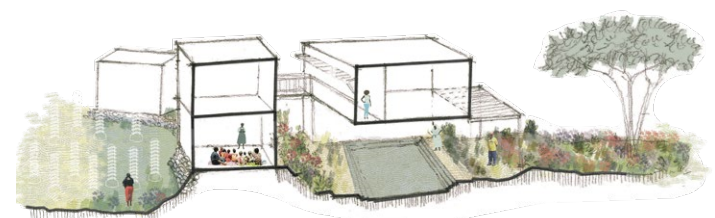
Moving across the site, the landscape changes in character: from dense forest with trees and shrubs, to high canopy areas with lawns, to organized gardens with pockets of seating.



The landscape changes in character: from dense forest with trees and shrubs, to high canopy areas with lawns, to organized gardens with pockets of seating.



Hand sketching is something I've always loved to do.



Thank you for your time!

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